

Staff Handbook

Kildare Craft Coffee Ltd | 2025 edition | Owner: Aoife Byrne | Café manager: Ciarán Doyle

1. Welcome

Welcome to Kildare Craft Coffee. We are a small, independent café on Main Street, Kilcock, serving speciality coffee, home-made cakes and light lunches. This handbook explains how we work and what you can expect from us. If anything is unclear, ask Ciarán, our café manager, or Aoife, the owner.

This handbook applies to all employees, full-time and part-time. Where a later written update from the owner differs from this handbook, the later update applies.

2. Opening hours

The café is open at the following times. Staff on opening shifts start 30 minutes before opening; staff on closing shifts finish 30 minutes after closing.

Day	Opening hours
Monday to Friday	07:00 to 17:00
Saturday	08:00 to 17:00
Sunday	09:00 to 15:00

The café is closed on Christmas Day, St Stephen's Day and Easter Sunday.

3. Rotas and shift swaps

The rota for the following week (Monday to Sunday) is published in the team rota app every Thursday by 15:00. Please check it every week; we do not send individual reminders.

To swap a shift, agree the swap with a colleague first, then request it in the rota app. A swap is only confirmed once the café manager approves it in the app. Unapproved swaps are treated as absence.

4. Pay

You are paid every second Friday by bank transfer. Payslips are emailed to you on the same day.

- **Overtime:** hours above 39 in a week are paid at 1.25 times your normal hourly rate. Overtime must be agreed in advance with the café manager.
- **Sunday premium:** hours worked on a Sunday are paid at 1.33 times your normal hourly rate.
- **Public holidays:** if you work on a public holiday, you receive an extra day's pay in addition to your pay for the hours worked.

Tips

Card and cash tips are pooled and shared each month in proportion to the hours each person worked that month. Tips are paid with your salary in the second pay of the following month, in line with Irish law. Tips are never used to make up basic pay.

5. Breaks

Shift length	Break
More than 4.5 hours	15-minute paid break
More than 6 hours	15-minute paid break plus a 30-minute unpaid lunch break

Breaks are taken at times agreed with the shift lead so that the counter is always covered. Staff may have one free hot drink and unlimited filtered water during each shift.

6. Annual leave

The leave year runs from 1 January to 31 December. Full-time staff are entitled to annual leave based on length of service:

Length of service	Annual leave (full-time)
Less than 3 years	20 days
3 to 5 years	22 days
More than 5 years	24 days

Part-time staff earn leave at 8% of the hours they work, in line with the Organisation of Working Time Act.

- Request leave in the rota app at least 2 weeks in advance.
- No more than 2 staff members may be on leave in the same week.
- Leave cannot be taken from 1 to 24 December, our busiest period.
- Up to 5 unused days may be carried over into the next leave year, but they must be used by 31 March or they are lost.

7. Sick leave

If you are sick and cannot work, phone the café manager at least 2 hours before your shift starts. A text message is not enough; we need to speak to you so that we can arrange cover.

A medical certificate is required for any absence of more than 2 consecutive days.

Sick pay: the first 5 sick days in each leave year are paid at 70% of your normal daily pay, up to a maximum of €110 per day. Further sick days are unpaid.

Staff who have had vomiting or diarrhoea must not return to work until they have been free of symptoms for 48 hours (see the Food Safety and Hygiene Procedures).

8. Compassionate leave

- Up to 3 days of paid leave on the death of an immediate family member (spouse or partner, child, parent, brother or sister).
- 1 day of paid leave on the death of another relative or for attending their funeral.

Speak to the café manager or the owner as soon as you can. We will always try to be flexible.

9. Staff discount

Staff receive 20% off food and drink when they are not on shift. The discount also applies to one guest accompanying the staff member. The discount does not apply to retail coffee beans or gift cards.

10. Uniform and appearance

We provide three black T-shirts and two aprons when you start, and replace them when worn out. You provide black trousers and closed, non-slip shoes.

For food safety, long hair must be tied back, and nail varnish and false nails are not allowed when working with food.

11. Training

All new staff complete food safety training (Level 1) within 4 weeks of starting. Barista training is given on the job during your first two weeks, and every barista must be signed off by the café manager before working the espresso machine alone.

12. Probation and notice

New staff have a probation period of 6 months.

Situation	Notice you must give
During probation	1 week
After probation (staff)	2 weeks
Café manager	4 weeks

13. Grievances

If you have a concern at work, raise it first with the café manager. If it is not resolved, or if it concerns the café manager, write to the owner, Aoife Byrne. You will receive a written response within 10 working days.

14. Disciplinary procedure

Our procedure has four stages: verbal warning, written warning, final written warning and dismissal. You have the right to be accompanied by a colleague at any disciplinary meeting.

Gross misconduct, such as theft, violence, serious breaches of food safety or working under the influence of alcohol or drugs, may lead to dismissal without going through the earlier stages.

15. Social media

You are welcome to share the café's own posts. Do not post photos or videos of customers, do not share our recipes, and do not discuss customers or colleagues online.